

TECHNICAL PROPOSAL

Norwegian Refugee Council, Somalia
BRCiS Consortium · KOBAC Action, funded by the European Union
Invitation to Bid, ITB reference I308377

Consultancy for the KOBAC Project Baseline Evaluation

Performance evaluation framework, tools and processes for the baseline, midline and endline,
and delivery of the baseline evaluation cycle in
Afgoye (Lower Shabelle) and Jowhar (Middle Shabelle)

Type of contract	Consultancy for a firm, under Invitation to Bid, ITB reference I308377
Assignment	Development of the performance evaluation framework, tools and processes for the baseline, midline and endline, and delivery of the baseline evaluation cycle
Locations	Afgoye district (Lower Shabelle) and Jowhar district (Middle Shabelle)
Duration	26 weeks, October 2026 to April 2027
Team Leader	Abdikarim Mohamed, Team Leader and Lead Evaluator
Submitted	September 2026 · offer valid for 120 calendar days

SUBMITTED BY



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September 2026

The Bid Analysis Committee

Norwegian Refugee Council, Somalia

Next to Haji Dol Garage, Airport Road, Wadajir District, Mogadishu, Banadir Region

RE: ITB I308377, Consultancy for the KOBAC Project Baseline Evaluation

Dear Members of the Bid Analysis Committee,

The Center for Research and Communication is pleased to submit this technical proposal in response to ITB I308377. We have read the Terms of Reference in full, and we are offering a team and a method built for the two things the assignment asks for at once. The first is a durable performance evaluation framework, with the tools and processes that serve the baseline, the midline and the endline alike. The second is the delivery of the baseline cycle itself, from instrument design through to a validated report that NCRDS, the BRCiS Consortium and the European Union can each use for the purpose they need it for.

Two features of this assignment shape our offer. The first is that the evaluation is contribution-focused rather than attribution-focused, and a baseline is where that discipline is set. We register the rival explanations before any result exists, so that the midline and endline cannot quietly absorb them into the Action's claim. The second is that the external evaluator does not collect primary data. Field collection sits with the BRCiS members and government focal persons, which means our value is concentrated in design, training, remote quality assurance, analysis and reporting. We have priced and staffed accordingly.

Our team is deliberately small and senior, so that the people who design the framework are the people who analyse the data and write the report. Four consultants carry 181 days of effort across the six-month cycle:

- **Abdikarim Mohamed, Team Leader and Lead Evaluator.** Accountable for overall quality and the single point of contact for the CMU. An independent evaluator and MEAL specialist with 12 years across Somalia, Sudan and East Africa, including RCT-based evaluation of livelihood interventions in fragile settings. He owns the evaluation framework, the contribution analysis, the KPI 1.1 government capacity rubric and every deliverable from D1 to D5.
- **Johnson Mugarra, MEAL Lead and Data Scientist.** Holds an MSc in Data Science and serves as CRC's technical lead consultant. He owns the sampling design and weighting, the programming of every instrument, the data pipeline and quality dashboards, the construction of the Self-Reliance Index and the municipal inclusivity composite, and the analysis, datasets, codebooks and syntax that make the midline and endline reproducible.
- **Asha Abdullahi Muhumed, Field Coordinator and Safeguarding Focal Point.** A community engagement and safeguarding specialist with over a decade in Somalia, including community engagement on the World Bank Somalia Urban Resilience Project II with Kismayo Municipality and a period as Senior Safeguarding Officer with CARE International. She owns NCRDS, municipal and community liaison, consent and access protocols, PSEA and SEA-SH compliance, and inclusion.
- **Abdimalik Mohamed Hussein, Field Manager and Qualitative Lead.** Holds an MSc in Finance and a BSc in Economics and Management Science, with 6 years of field M&E and large survey management in fragile Somalia. He owns enumerator training and certification, field supervision including back-checks and audio audits, the qualitative guides, and thematic coding.

CRC is a Somali firm, registered and tax-compliant in Somalia, with 13 years of work for UN agencies, international NGOs and Federal and Member State institutions. We have delivered evaluation and research assignments in Afgoye, Jowhar and the wider Shabelle corridor, and we hold an active working relationship with the BRCiS Consortium. Two comparable assignments, with contactable referees, are set out in Annex C.

We confirm that this proposal is valid for 120 calendar days from the submission deadline, that our quoted prices are firm and fixed and inclusive of all applicable taxes, and that we accept the terms of the Invitation to Bid. Sections 5 to 9 are completed, signed and stamped, and our financial proposal is submitted as a separate document as Section 8 requires. We would welcome the chance to discuss the approach with the CMU and NCRDS.

Yours sincerely,

Mohamud Madahey

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I. Executive summary

KOBAC asks its evaluator for two things that are usually treated separately: a measurement architecture that will still be intact in 2029, and a baseline that is useful to a government partner in early 2027. This proposal is built so that the first is not sacrificed to the second, and the framework it proposes is built once and used three times. One question bank, one sampling frame, one set of panel identifiers, one codebook and one syntax repository serve all three waves. The Self-Reliance Index is taken from the Refugee Self-Reliance Initiative instrument that AARAN and URBANISE already use, without local modification, because a Self-Reliance Index score that cannot be compared across BRCiS projects is worth very little to the Consortium. Where KOBAC needs something new, principally the municipal inclusivity and accountability composite under KPI 1.3 and the government capacity rubric under KPI 1.1, we build it to a published specification, pilot it, and document its weighting so the midline team can reproduce it exactly.

The baseline itself covers Impact, Outcome 1 and Outcome 2 at population level in Afgoye and Jowhar. Outcome 3 is not baselined now. Its participants are not yet identified, and the TOR is right that capturing their pre-intervention values at registration in early Year 2 is the methodologically sound course. We will build the Outcome 3 KPI module into the participant registration tool so that those values are captured at the point of entry, before any support is provided, and so that they are structured to sit in the same dataset as the population-level data when the midline reads them together.

Our quantitative design is a stratified multi-stage cluster survey with a panel spine: 1,512 households across 126 clusters, 756 per district, sized for district-level reporting at 95 per cent confidence with a 5 per cent margin of error, adjusted for clustering, non-response and expected attrition between waves. The qualitative design comprises sixteen focus group discussions, thirty-four key informant interviews including the ten virtual interviews the TOR specifies for inception, and four rubric assessment panels. All field collection is led by the BRCiS members and government focal persons, as the TOR directs, with CRC providing remote technical oversight, daily data quality assurance and enumerator performance management.

Contribution analysis runs through the whole design. It is not a chapter. At baseline there is no change to attribute, so what contribution analysis does here is establish the architecture: the results chain written out for each outcome, every assumption named, and the rival explanations registered in a context monitoring log that runs from inception to endline. Writing down the influence of other durable solutions investments, of National Transformation Plan reform, of new displacement inflows and of post El Nino flooding now, before any result exists, is what prevents the endline from reading them back into the Action's evidence.

2. CRC and relevant experience

CRC is a Mogadishu-based research, evaluation, MEAL and field operations firm, registered in Somalia as a limited liability company and tax-compliant with the Federal Government of Somalia. Over 13 years we have delivered baselines, endlines, perception surveys, accountability assessments and capacity studies for UN agencies, international NGOs and Federal and Member State institutions, working through complex security, access and logistical constraints. We maintain resident field capacity across South Central Somalia, including the Shabelle corridor that Afgoye and Jowhar sit on, and we work in Maay and Maxaa Tiri as well as English.

Three institutional strengths bear directly on this assignment. The first is longitudinal, mixed-methods evaluation design in displacement-affected settings, including panel construction and index measurement. The second is multi-stakeholder and government facilitation, since this evaluation is co-owned by a government body, a consortium management unit, four implementing partners and a donor, and the consultant has to hold all of them to one methodology. The third is remote quality assurance of partner-led data collection, which is the specific delivery model the TOR sets out and which is harder than running your own enumerators, because the protocol, the training and the dashboards have to carry the quality that direct supervision would otherwise carry.

2.1 Two comparable assignments

Full detail, with contactable referees, is at Annex C. Both are evaluations for international humanitarian organisations working through consortium or multi-stakeholder arrangements, which the ITB records as a preference.

Assignment	Client and arrangement	Why it is comparable
Endline Evaluation of the Multi-sectoral Emergency Response Project, Bay, Galgadud, Mudug and Hiran regions	International Rescue Committee, multi-sector consortium delivery	Mixed-methods outcome evaluation against a donor logframe, with household survey, FGDs and KIIs triangulated into one report; disaggregation by location, gender, age and displacement status; partner-supported field collection under CRC technical oversight.

Assignment	Client and arrangement	Why it is comparable
Assessment of Accountability to Affected Populations in 24 districts of South Central Somalia	UNICEF Somalia, with Federal and State authorities	Large multi-district design across South Central Somalia including the Shabelle corridor; perception measurement of institutional responsiveness and accountability, which is the same measurement problem as KPI 1.3; direct government engagement at Federal and local level.

Table 1. Comparable assignments. Both are documented at Annex C with contract values, dates and referees.

2.2 Selected consultancy portfolio

Client	Assignment
International Rescue Committee	Client Exit Interviews under the WISH 2 Programme in Banadir, Lower Shabelle, Bay, Galgaduud and Mudug
International Rescue Committee	Endline evaluation of the Multi-sectoral Emergency Response Project in Bay, Galgaduud, Mudug and Hiran
UNICEF Somalia	Assessment of Accountability to Affected Populations in 24 districts of South Central Somalia
UNICEF Somalia	Community awareness, accountability and engagement for Environmental and Social Standards, AfDB-funded WASH programme; and post-campaign communication assessment, South Central Somalia
SOS Children's Villages	Baseline and market-based analysis for climate-smart and sustainable farming in Baidoa
Norwegian Church Aid	End-line assessment for NORAD, 2021 to 2025
Islamic Relief / Polish Humanitarian Action	Scaling humanitarian response for displaced persons and host communities in Berdale and Dinsoor; women's empowerment and resilient communities, South Central Somalia
Norwegian Refugee Council, BRCiS	Documentation of whole-system design frameworks for the KOBAC Action, including O&M roles and responsibilities

Table 2. Selected assignments over the past 5 years. The full 5-year schedule is submitted on the Section 7 form.

3. Understanding of the assignment

KOBAC is a thirty-six month, EU-funded Action delivered by the BRCiS Consortium with the Federal Government of Somalia, and specifically with the National Centre for Rural Development and Durable Solutions, in the displacement-affected secondary cities of Afgoye and Jowhar. Implementation began in February 2026 through NRC, Concern Worldwide, WARDI and HIJRA. Its three outcomes depend on one another: authorities that coordinate and deliver inclusive urban services accountable to displacement-affected communities; authorities, communities and the private sector jointly designing, delivering and maintaining sustainable urban infrastructure; and displacement-affected communities whose livelihoods are tied directly to the operation and maintenance of that infrastructure. The Action sits inside the National Solutions Pathway Action Plan 2024 to 2029 and the National Transformation Plan 2025 to 2029, which means its evidence has to be legible to a government reporting system as well as a donor one.

We read this consultancy as three jobs that have to be done in one sequence. The first is to build the performance evaluation framework, the tools and the processes that will carry all three waves. The second is to run the baseline cycle: establish pre-intervention benchmarks for Impact, Outcome 1 and Outcome 2 at population level, understand the contextual factors and risks that could affect implementation, and produce recommendations that keep delivery approaches contextually relevant from the outset. The third is to hand over cleanly, through a co-facilitated validation and dissemination workshop and a data package that the separately contracted midline and endline teams can pick up without re-inventing anything.

3.1 Four features of the TOR that shape the design

The evaluator designs and assures; the partners collect

The TOR is explicit that all field data collection is led by the implementing partners and government focal persons, and that the external evaluator will not undertake primary data collection in the field. This is a sound arrangement in Afgoye and Jowhar, and it changes where quality has to be engineered. When you supervise your own enumerators, you can correct in person. When partners collect, quality has to be built into the instrument, the training, the protocol and the monitoring dashboard, because those are the only levers that reach the field. Our Phase 2 and Phase 3 design is written around that constraint, and it is why we place 80 of our 181 consultant days in instrument development and field oversight.

What a contribution lens commits us to

The TOR asks for a contribution analysis lens and says so more than once. This is a design choice with consequences for what we build, and we have treated it as one. It means we do not propose a control group or a counterfactual comparison arm, both of which would be ethically and practically difficult in these districts and neither of which the TOR asks for. It means instead that the credibility of the eventual claim rests on how thoroughly the results chain is articulated and how honestly the rival explanations are tested. That work belongs at baseline, and Section 4 sets out how we do it.

Outcome 3 is deliberately out of scope at baseline

Outcome 3 participants, meaning the business groups, peri-urban food producers and TVET graduates who will receive intensive livelihood support, are not yet identified. Collecting Outcome 3 baseline values from a general population sample would produce numbers that are not comparable with the midline values collected from actual participants, and would understate or overstate change depending on how selection works. The TOR resolves this correctly by capturing Outcome 3 values at participant registration in early Year 2. Our obligation under this contract is to design the Outcome 3 KPI questionnaire so that the CMU can integrate it into the registration tool, and to specify how those values will later join the main dataset. We treat that as a deliverable in its own right.

Two indicators need instruments that do not yet exist

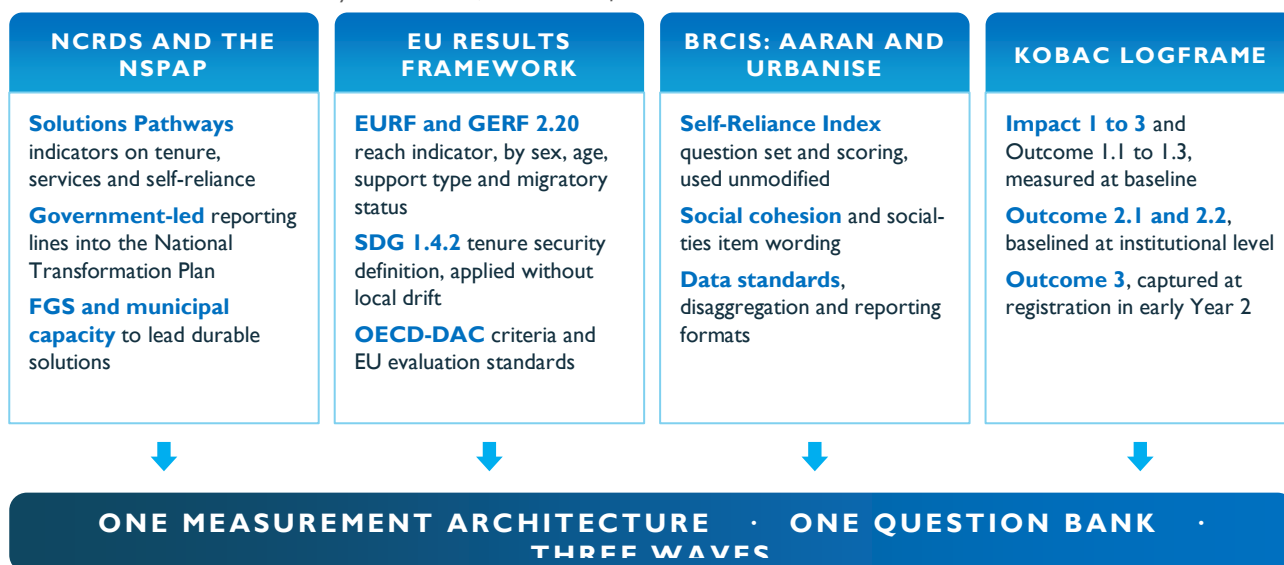
KPI 1.1 requires a standardised assessment rubric for government performance in leading and coordinating inclusive durable solutions, measured at baseline and endline, with the target recorded as to be determined. KPI 1.3 requires a perception composite index of municipal inclusivity and accountability that the TOR states BRCiS will develop and construct during inception. Both are instruments where the design decisions made now determine whether the endline can detect change at all. Section 4.4 sets out how we build each, and Section 6.2 how each is scored and validated.

3.2 Context in Afgoye and Jowhar

Both districts sit on the Shabelle river and both have absorbed large displaced populations into urban and peri-urban areas that were not planned for them. Recurrent riverine flooding, strained drainage and fragile embankments interact with rapid displacement-driven growth, insecure tenure and municipalities whose revenue base and technical staffing are thin relative to the mandate the National Solutions Pathway Action Plan gives them. The TOR notes that the baseline workplan is provisional in part because of post El Nino flooding impact, and our workplan carries that risk explicitly: the Phase 3 collection window has float, the protocol includes a documented cluster substitution rule, and the context monitoring log records any flooding or access event that could affect a district-level estimate, so that the midline reads the baseline correctly, with the disruption visible in the record.

Figure 1. One evaluation framework, four alignment obligations

What KOBAC measurement has to stay consistent with, and what the framework returns to each audience



For NCRDS

A government-owned evidence benchmark against the National Solutions Pathway Action Plan, and a defensible score for its own

For BRCiS and the CMU

Baseline values comparable with AARAN and URBANISE, and a tool set the midline and endline reuse without redesign.

For the EU

OECD-DAC structured findings, EURF-compliant disaggregation, and a contribution claim that stays inside what the Action can show.

4. Performance evaluation framework and evaluation questions

Scored under Section 3, Clause 26.1: a proposed performance evaluation framework and evaluation questions, 10 points.

4.1 The framework in one paragraph

The framework has four layers. At the top, the KOBAC theory of change, written out as three results chains with every assumption named. Below it, the OECD-DAC criteria, which organise the evaluation questions and the reporting structure. Below that, the logframe KPIs, each mapped to a named instrument, a named respondent, a defined disaggregation and a stated analysis method. At the base, the measurement instruments themselves, drawn from AARAN and URBANISE wherever an equivalent already exists and purpose-built to a published specification where it does not. Contribution analysis is not a fifth layer. It is the reasoning that connects them, and it is applied at each wave.

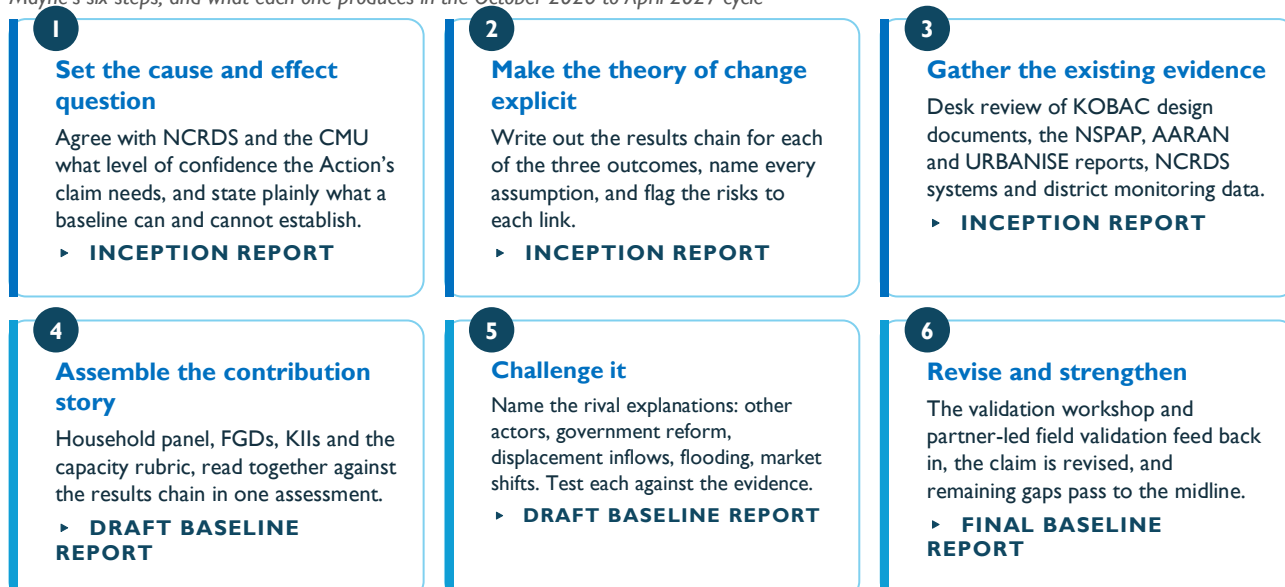
4.2 Applying contribution analysis to a baseline

We follow the six-step contribution analysis sequence. Steps one to three are inception work and produce the contribution architecture: the cause and effect question is agreed with NCRDS and the CMU, including how confident the Action needs to be able to be in its eventual claim; the theory of change is made explicit for each outcome, with assumptions and risks attached to every link; and the existing evidence is assembled from KOBAC design documents, the National Solutions Pathway Action Plan, AARAN and URBANISE reports, NCRDS systems and district monitoring data. Steps 4 to 6 are applied to the starting position: the contribution story is assembled from the household panel, the qualitative work and the rubric read together; the rival explanations are tested against that evidence; and the resulting account is revised through the validation workshop and the partner-led field-level validation.

The operational product of this is a context monitoring log, opened at inception and maintained to endline, in which every plausible external influence on a KOBAC indicator is recorded with a date, a source and an assessment of which indicators it touches. Other durable solutions investments in the two districts, National Transformation Plan reform, new displacement inflows, flooding and market or remittance movements all sit in that log from the start. The log is handed to the midline team as part of the data package. Its purpose is to make the eventual contribution claim falsifiable, which is what distinguishes contribution analysis from a narrative assertion of success.

Figure 2. Contribution analysis, applied to a baseline

Mayne's six steps, and what each one produces in the October 2026 to April 2027 cycle



Rival explanations registered at baseline

- Other durable solutions investments in Afgoye and Jowhar, including prior EU-funded work
- Federal and Banadir-level reform driven by the National Transformation Plan
- New displacement inflows changing the population composition between waves
- Post El Nino flooding and seasonal shocks on the Shabelle
- Remittance and market movements affecting self-reliance independently of the Action

How each one is handled

- Recorded in a context monitoring log maintained from inception to endline
- Tested in key informant interviews with authorities and non-KOBAC actors in both districts
- Controlled for in analysis through covariates and, where warranted, stratified estimates
- Reported openly in the contribution narrative, and kept out of the Action's own claim

4.3 Evaluation questions

The questions below are proposed for refinement with NCRDS, the CMU and the EU during inception, and the agreed set will be fixed in the inception report. They are organised by OECD-DAC criterion, and each is answerable from at least two of the instruments described in Section 5.

OECD-DAC criterion	Evaluation questions
Relevance	To what extent do the KOBAC delivery approaches match the priorities that displacement-affected communities, local authorities and NCRDS identify at baseline in Afgoye and Jowhar, and where do they diverge? Which contextual factors, including post El Nino flooding, displacement inflows, tenure insecurity and municipal revenue constraints, are most likely to shape whether the Action remains relevant over its 36 months?
Coherence and alignment	How consistent are the KOBAC measurement instruments with those used by AARAN and URBANISE, and what degree of interoperability can be achieved without losing KOBAC-specific content? Where do the Action, NCRDS systems and other durable solutions investments in the two districts overlap, reinforce or compete with one another?
Effectiveness	What are the pre-intervention values of every Impact, Outcome 1 and Outcome 2 KPI, at population level and disaggregated by location, gender, age and displacement status? What is the current performance of federal and municipal authorities in leading and coordinating inclusive durable solutions, assessed against a standardised rubric, and what specifically constrains it? What proportion of displaced persons hold legally recognised documentation for their land, and what proportion perceive their rights to land as secure, compared with the national average?
Efficiency	Which delivery arrangements between the CMU, NCRDS, the BRCiS members and the municipalities are already working, and where does the baseline evidence point to avoidable duplication or delay?
Impact and contribution	What plausible contribution can the Action be expected to make to the observed starting position, once the influence of other actors, policies and contextual events is accounted for? Which assumptions in the KOBAC theory of change are already under strain at baseline, and what would have to be true for the intended results chain to hold?
Sustainability	What institutional and technical capacity do local authorities currently hold to operate and maintain green urban infrastructure, and what is the realistic distance to the Outcome 2 targets? What financing, staffing and maintenance arrangements are in place at baseline that would allow results to persist beyond the Action?
Cross-cutting	How do gender, age, disability and displacement status shape access to services, tenure security, social ties and participation in municipal planning at baseline? What risks to safety, dignity and confidentiality does the evaluation itself carry, and how are they controlled?

Table 3. Proposed evaluation questions by OECD-DAC criterion, for confirmation at inception.

4.4 Measurement instruments the framework develops

Six instruments are built under this contract. Four are adopted or adapted from existing BRCiS or international practice so that KOBAC results are comparable with AARAN, URBANISE and EU reporting. Two are purpose-built because no adequate equivalent exists. Every one of them is specified in the inception report and delivered in the D2 tool pack.

Instrument	Serves	How it is built	Comparability
Household survey module: Self-Reliance Index	Impact KPI 2	The Refugee Self-Reliance Initiative Self-Reliance Index question set, applied without modification to question wording, scale or scoring, with the standard domain structure retained.	Directly comparable with AARAN and URBANISE, and with the wider Self-Reliance Index evidence base.

Instrument	Serves	How it is built	Comparability
Household survey module: social ties and cohesion	Impact KPI 3	Item set aligned with the BRCiS social cohesion measures already in use, with the reference group definition for "diverse groups" fixed at inception so that it means the same thing in every wave.	Comparable with BRCiS projects; the reference group definition is the single decision that protects that.
Household survey module: tenure security	Outcome 1 KPI 1.2	Built to the SDG 1.4.2 two-part definition: legally recognised documentation, and perceived security of rights to land. Both parts asked separately, with tenure type recorded, and results set against the national average.	Comparable with SDG reporting and with the national average the KPI requires as a benchmark.
Outcome 3 KPI questionnaire for the participant registration tool	Outcome 3 KPIs 3.1 to 3.3	A short module designed for integration into the CMU participant registration tool, capturing pre-support values for group business operation and revenue, resilience design practice adoption and employment status, with the same variable names and codes as the main dataset.	Designed so Year 2 registration data joins the baseline dataset without recoding.
Government capacity rubric (purpose-built)	Outcome 1 KPI 1.1	A standardised rubric with four to six domains covering coordination, planning, inclusion of displacement-affected communities, data use and service delivery oversight. Each domain has four defined performance levels with observable descriptors and a stated evidence requirement. Scored from documentary evidence, a facilitated self-assessment with the institution, and independent verification, in that order.	Purpose-built for KOBAC. Designed for endline re-application by a different team, which is why every descriptor is observable.
Municipal inclusivity and accountability composite index (purpose-built)	Outcome 1 KPI 1.3	Constructed with the CMU during inception, as the TOR anticipates. Candidate items drawn from resident perceptions of participation in planning, responsiveness to complaints, fairness of service allocation and information transparency. Dimensionality tested on the baseline data, internal consistency reported, and weighting documented and published.	Purpose-built. The published weighting and syntax are what make the midline value comparable.

Table 4. The six measurement instruments developed under this contract, and the basis of each.

4.5 Evaluation matrix

The matrix below is the working link between each evaluation objective, the indicators that answer it, the source, the collection method and the analysis. It is reproduced in the inception report with the agreed question set and becomes the reporting skeleton for the baseline report.

Evaluation objective	Indicators and measures	Source	Collection method	Analysis
Establish pre-intervention benchmarks for Impact KPIs at population level	Reach against EURF/GERF 2.20; Self-Reliance Index score; per cent reporting strong social ties with diverse groups	Household panel survey; ITT and partner monitoring data for the reach indicator	Structured household survey across 126 clusters, panel identifiers assigned	Weighted proportions and means with 95 per cent confidence intervals, disaggregated by location, gender, age and displacement status
Establish Outcome 1 benchmarks on government capacity, tenure and perceptions	KPI 1.1 rubric score; KPI 1.2 documented and perceived tenure security against national average; KPI 1.3 municipal inclusivity composite	Rubric panels; household survey; KIIs with authorities, HLP actors and service providers	Four rubric panels; household modules; 24 baseline KIIs	Rubric scoring with evidence trail; SDG 1.4.2 two-part estimation; composite index construction with dimensionality and reliability reported
Establish Outcome 2 benchmarks on infrastructure functionality and official competencies	KPI 2.1 O&M compliance and sustained functionality; KPI 2.2 official competency improvement	Municipal and BRCiS asset records; KIIs with municipal works departments; pre-training competency assessment design	Document review; KIIs; competency instrument specified for partner administration	Institutional-level descriptive baseline; explicit statement that the baseline for 2.1 is the pre-handover position, with the measurement point defined for endline

Evaluation objective	Indicators and measures	Source	Collection method	Analysis
Understand contextual factors and risks affecting implementation	Documented socio-economic, environmental, governance and security factors; enabling and constraining conditions mapped	Desk review; 10 inception KIs; 24 baseline KIs; 16 FGDs; context monitoring log	Desk review, semi-structured interviews, participatory focus groups	Thematic analysis against the results chains; context mapping matrix; risk register with likelihood and indicator exposure
Provide actionable recommendations, and establish the contribution architecture for midline and endline	Gaps between the baseline position and the delivery approaches already defined through government and community consultation; articulated results chains, named assumptions, registered rival explanations	Synthesis of all strands; validation workshop and partner-led field validation; design documents, KIs and the context monitoring log	Facilitated validation and reflection sessions; desk review and stakeholder consultation at inception	Gap analysis against outcome targets; recommendations ranked by feasibility and by owning actor; contribution analysis steps 1 to 3 documented and steps 4 to 6 applied to the starting position

Table 5. Evaluation matrix. The baseline report is structured against these six objectives.

5. Sampling methodology and data collection strategies

Scored under Section 3, Clause 26.1: sampling methodology and data collection strategies, 10 points.

5.1 Population, frame and domains

The survey population is the resident population of the KOBAC target locations in Afgoye and Jowhar districts, comprising internally displaced persons, returnees and refugee-returnees, and host community members. Each district is a reporting domain in its own right, because the Action is area-based and because NCRDS and the municipalities will use the findings district by district. The sampling frame will be assembled during inception from the settlement and enumeration area lists held by NCRDS, the BRCiS members and the two municipalities, cross-checked against the most recent displacement site data. Where the frame is incomplete for a settlement, a rapid listing is conducted before selection in that cluster. We do not substitute a neighbouring one, since substitution at frame stage is the most common silent source of bias in Somali urban surveys.

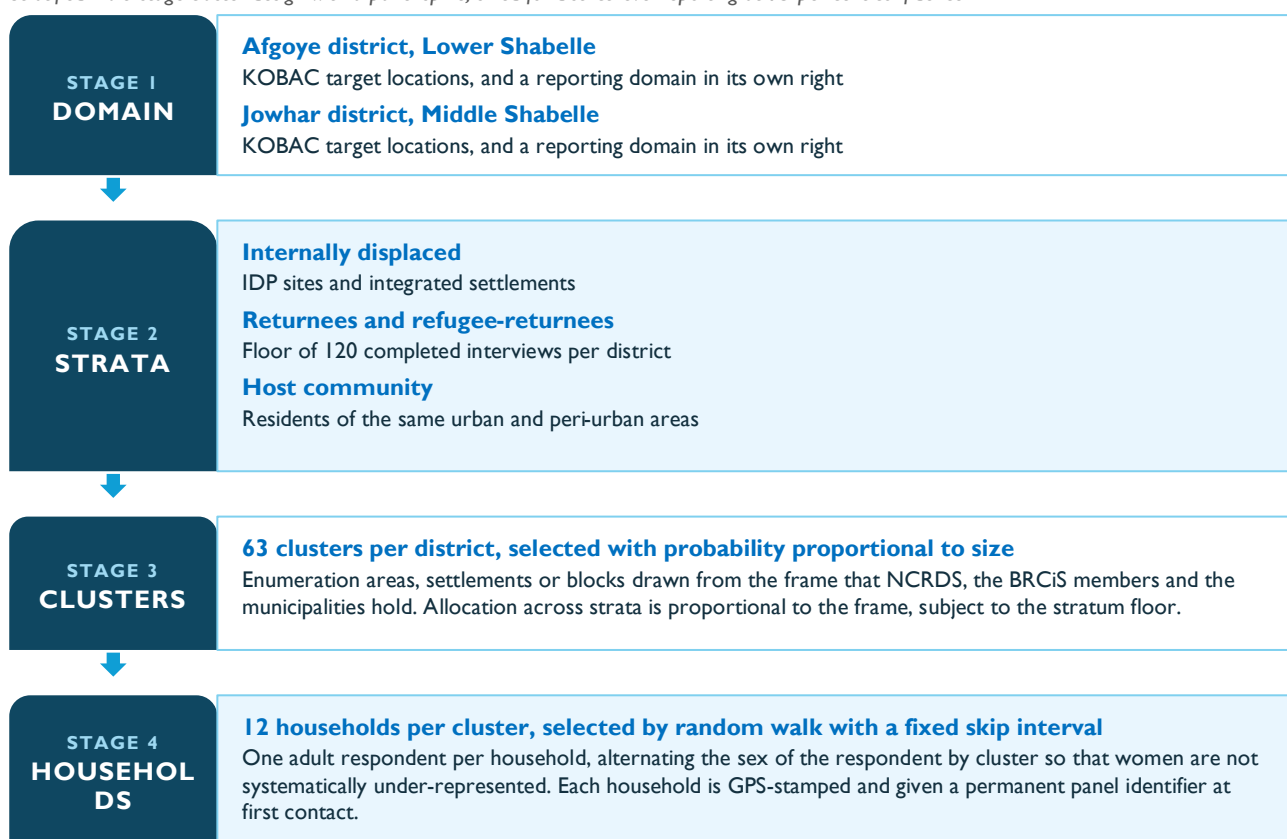
5.2 Design and sample size

We propose a stratified multi-stage cluster design with a panel spine. Districts are the domains; displacement status is the stratum; clusters are selected with probability proportional to size; and households are selected within cluster by random walk with a fixed skip interval. The panel spine means that every sampled household receives a permanent identifier, GPS coordinates and two contact points at first visit, so that the same households can be revisited at midline and endline. This is what converts a repeated cross-section into a panel, and it costs almost nothing at baseline while being impossible to add retrospectively.

The sample is sized for district-level estimation at 95 per cent confidence with a 5 per cent margin of error, on a proportion at maximum variance, then adjusted in three steps. The result is 63 clusters of 12 households in each district, 756 households per district and 1,512 in total. The design effect of clustering is taken at 1.55, from 12 households per cluster and an intra-cluster correlation of 0.05, consistent with what we have observed on comparable urban household surveys in South Central Somalia. Non-response and non-contact are taken at 8 per cent. A 15 per cent panel reserve is added so the midline and endline retain power after attrition, which in displacement-affected urban settings is the binding constraint on a longitudinal design.

Figure 3. Sampling design and sample size derivation

Stratified multi-stage cluster design with a panel spine, sized for district-level reporting at 95 per cent confidence



SAMPLE SIZE DERIVATION, PER DISTRICT

Baseline sample for a proportion, maximum variance $z = 1.96$, $p = 0.5$, margin of error 0.05		385
Adjusted for the design effect of clustering $DEFF = 1.55$ at 12 households per cluster, ICC 0.05		597
Adjusted for non-response and non-contact 8 per cent		649
Panel reserve, so the midline and endline keep their power 15 per cent expected attrition		746
Allocated sample, per district 63 clusters $\times$ 12 households		756
Total baseline sample, both districts 126 clusters		1,512

16 focus group discussions

Eight segments per district: IDP women, IDP men, host women, host men, youth, persons with disabilities, returnees, and community and religious leaders. Eight to ten participants each, women's groups facilitated by women.

34 key informant interviews

10 virtual at inception with NCRDS, the CMU, the EU, NRC, Concern Worldwide, WARDI, HIJRA and the municipalities. 24 during baseline with authorities, service providers, HLP actors and private operators.

4 rubric assessment panels

Two at federal level with NCRDS and the line ministry, one in each municipality, scoring KPI 1.1 against documentary evidence, self-assessment and independent verification.

Allocation across strata within each district is proportional to the frame, subject to a floor of 120 completed interviews per stratum so that every stratum remains separately reportable, with a wider confidence interval that we will state plainly. Design weights are constructed as the inverse of the selection probability at each stage, adjusted for non-response within cluster and calibrated to the frame totals by district and displacement status. All estimates are reported weighted, with unweighted counts shown alongside, and all variance estimation accounts for the design through Taylor linearisation.

5.3 Qualitative sampling

Qualitative sampling is purposive and stratified to reach the voices that a household survey systematically under-hears. Sixteen focus group discussions are held, eight in each district, segmented as IDP women, IDP men, host women, host men, youth, persons with disabilities, returnees, and community and religious leaders. Each group has eight to ten participants. Women's and youth groups are facilitated by female staff, because in these districts that materially changes what is said. Groups are held in locations selected for safety and ease of access, and never in a location associated with a single clan or authority.

Thirty-four key informant interviews are conducted. Ten are the virtual interviews the TOR specifies for the inception period, with NCRDS, the BRCiS CMU, the EU, the Federal Government of Somalia, NRC, Concern Worldwide, WARDI, HIJRA and the Afgoye and Jowhar municipalities. Twenty-four are conducted during the baseline period, twelve per district, with municipal works and planning departments, HLP and land administration actors, service providers, private operators, women's and youth representative bodies, and community leaders. Four rubric assessment panels provide the structured evidence for KPI 1.1, two at federal level and one in each municipality.

5.4 Instruments, translation and programming

All instruments are drafted in English, translated into Somali covering both Maay and Maxaa Tiri where the district requires it, and independently back-translated by a translator who has not seen the English original. Back-translation discrepancies are resolved item by item and the resolution is recorded, because for index items a small wording drift changes the score without changing the apparent instrument. The household questionnaire is programmed in SurveyCTO with hard and soft constraints, skip logic, automatic consistency checks between related items, GPS capture, audio audit on a random subset of interviews, and case management that links a household to its panel identifier. Qualitative guides are semi-structured, with probes written to elicit the specific evidence the contribution analysis needs.

A pilot is run in a non-sample site in week seven, with at least 30 household interviews and 2 focus group discussions. The pilot tests comprehension, sequencing, interview duration, the skip logic and, for the two purpose-built instruments, whether the response distribution has enough variation to detect change later. Instruments are corrected before launch and the changes are documented in the D2 tool pack.

5.5 Training the people who will collect the data

The TOR asks the consultant to provide training to BRCiS and NCRDS staff on evaluation tools and methodologies prior to baseline data collection, and to lead a one-day in-person session in Mogadishu. We treat that day as the single most consequential day in the whole assignment, because it is the last moment at which we can influence what happens in the field. It covers the evaluation purpose and the logframe, every instrument section by section, the sampling and household selection protocol, consent and safeguarding including referral pathways, the digital tool, and the data quality rules that will be applied to their work. It includes practical exercises and a role-played interview. Participants take a short pre-test and post-test, and the results are reported in the D2 training report, so that the CMU can see how far comprehension actually moved.

We supplement the in-person day with two remote sessions in the first week of collection, one for supervisors on back-checks and one for enumerators on the errors the dashboard has already flagged. These cost little and address the main weakness of a one-day model, which is that most comprehension problems only surface once real interviews begin.

5.6 Remote technical oversight and data quality assurance

During collection, CRC operates on a daily quality cycle. Incoming submissions are reviewed each morning against a standing rule set: duration outliers at both ends, straight-lining and low variance within scales, item non-response above threshold, GPS points outside the assigned cluster, consistency failures between linked items, and enumerator-level deviation from the sample mean on key indicators. 10 per cent of interviews receive a telephone back-check on a short verification instrument, and audio audits are reviewed for consent delivery and question fidelity. Findings go back to supervisors the same day, and an enumerator performance log tracks flags by individual so that retraining or removal follows a pattern across an enumerator's work.

A weekly data quality assurance return goes to the CMU throughout Phase 3, covering completion against the cluster plan, response rates by stratum, the flags raised and closed, and any access or security event affecting the plan. This is what makes the oversight visible to the CMU and checkable against the record.

Quality risk	Control	Evidence produced
Enumerator drift in wording or probing	Audio audit of a random subset; supervisor spot checks; same-day feedback	Audio audit log with fidelity ratings by enumerator
Fabricated or partially fabricated interviews	Telephone back-check on 10 per cent; GPS verification against cluster boundary; duration analysis	Back-check reconciliation report; GPS exception list

Quality risk	Control	Evidence produced
Wrong household selected	Random walk protocol with fixed skip; selection recorded in the instrument; supervisor re-walk on a sample of clusters	Selection audit by cluster
Index items answered mechanically	Within-scale variance checks; attention items; enumerator-level distribution comparison	Variance flag report by scale and enumerator
Panel identifiers lost or duplicated	Identifier generated in the instrument, GPS and two contacts captured, duplicate check run nightly	Panel register, verified and handed to the midline team

Table 6. The data quality assurance rule set applied during partner-led collection.

6. Data analysis approach

Scored under Section 3, Clause 26.1: data analysis approaches, 10 points.

6.1 Quantitative analysis

Analysis is conducted in Stata with a version-controlled syntax repository, and every table in the report is produced by a script, so that the midline can reproduce it exactly. Cleaning is documented as code: range and logic checks, outlier review with a stated rule for treatment, missing data documented by variable with the mechanism assessed, and a complete audit trail from raw to analysis dataset.

For the baseline, the primary output is a set of benchmark estimates for every Impact, Outcome 1 and Outcome 2 KPI: weighted proportions or means with 95 per cent confidence intervals and design-based standard errors, disaggregated by location, gender, age band and displacement status, with unweighted denominators shown. Where a KPI target is recorded as to be determined, as it is for the Self-Reliance Index, the KPI 1.1 rubric and the KPI 1.3 composite, the baseline estimate and its distribution are what allow a defensible target to be set, and we will propose one for each with the reasoning shown.

Beyond the benchmarks we run the analysis that makes a baseline useful as well as complete. Equity gaps are tested formally between displacement status groups and between women and men, so that a difference reported as meaningful is distinguished from one inside the confidence interval. Associations between tenure security, self-reliance, social ties and perceptions of municipal inclusivity are examined, because the theory of change asserts those links and the baseline is the first chance to see whether they hold here. Results carry effect sizes alongside significance, and the comparisons of interest are pre-specified in the inception report, before any testing begins.

6.2 Index and rubric construction

The Self-Reliance Index is scored using the published Refugee Self-Reliance Initiative scoring rules, unmodified, with domain scores and the composite reported and the distribution shown so that movement between waves stays interpretable at item level.

The municipal inclusivity and accountability composite is constructed in four documented steps. Candidate items are agreed with the CMU at inception and piloted. Dimensionality is examined on the baseline data using exploratory factor analysis, and the retained structure is reported with loadings. Internal consistency is reported per dimension. The weighting decision, whether equal weighting or factor-derived, is taken explicitly and justified in the report, and the syntax is published. A composite whose construction is not published cannot be reproduced at midline, and an index that cannot be reproduced cannot measure change.

The KPI 1.1 government capacity rubric is scored in three passes. First, documentary evidence is assessed against each domain descriptor by two team members independently, with disagreements recorded and resolved by discussion, never averaged. Second, a facilitated self-assessment is conducted with the institution, which is both a measurement step and a capacity-strengthening one, since the act of scoring against observable descriptors tends to clarify for an institution what the standard actually is. Third, the score is verified independently against the KII evidence and, where relevant, against the observations of other actors. The final score carries an evidence citation for every domain, so that the endline team can see what a given level meant in 2026.

6.3 Qualitative analysis

Recordings are transcribed in Somali and translated to English, with a 10 per cent quality check of translation against the original audio. Coding is done in NVivo with a framework that is deductive from the results chains and the evaluation questions, and inductive for themes that the framework does not anticipate, which is where the unintended effects the TOR asks about usually first appear. Two coders code an overlapping subset and inter-coder agreement is assessed and reported. Analysis is by theme and by respondent segment, so that differences between IDP women and host men, for example, survive into the reporting.

6.4 Integration and the contribution assessment

Integration is not a concluding chapter in which quantitative and qualitative findings are placed side by side. Findings are brought together against each link in the results chains, in a triangulation matrix that records, for every assertion in the baseline report, which strands support it, which qualify it and which contradict it. Where strands disagree, the disagreement is reported and the likely reason examined, because a contradiction between what a survey measures and what a focus group says is usually informative.

The contribution assessment that follows applies steps four to six of the sequence to the starting position: which assumptions in the theory of change already hold in Afgoye and Jowhar, which are visibly under strain, which other actors are already moving the same indicators, and what would have to be true for the intended results chain to deliver. The output is a written contribution architecture handed to the midline, together with the context monitoring log and a register of the rival explanations that the midline will have to test.

6.5 Reproducibility and the data package

Everything the midline and endline need is delivered as a package at D5: de-identified analysis datasets in Stata and CSV, the panel register, annotated codebooks, the full cleaning and analysis syntax, the index construction scripts with weighting decisions recorded, the qualitative codebook and coded extracts, the rubric evidence files, and the context monitoring log. The point of the package is that a different firm, contracted separately for the midline, can produce a comparable value without contacting us.

7. Workplan, deliverables and timeline

Scored under Section 3, Clause 26.1: a detailed workplan with deliverables and associated timelines, 10 points.

Our plan runs 26 weeks from contract signature, which the ITB schedules for 5 October 2026, to close-out in April 2027. It meets each date the TOR sets: the inception report in October 2026, baseline collection rolling out in November 2026, a draft baseline report in January 2027 and the dissemination workshop in February 2027. Every deliverable requires written CMU approval before the next phase closes. Where the TOR notes that the workplan is provisional and subject to post El Nino flooding impact, we have carried float in the Phase 3 collection window and set out the substitution and re-scheduling rules in the risk table at Section 9.

Phase	Period	What happens	CRC days
Phase 1 Inception and framework design	Weeks 1 to 4 October 2026	Kick-off and data-sharing agreements; desk review of KOBAC design documents, the NSPAP, the EU framework and the AARAN and URBANISE tools; 10 virtual key informant interviews; theory of change articulation and evaluation questions agreed; indicator matrix built; sampling frame reviewed with NCRDS and the BRCiS members and allocation fixed.	33
Phase 2 Instruments, translation and training	Weeks 5 to 8 November 2026	Household questionnaire, FGD and KII guides and the KPI 1.1 rubric drafted; the KPI 1.3 composite specified with the CMU; the Outcome 3 registration module built; Somali translation and independent back-translation; SurveyCTO programming; the one-day in-person training in Mogadishu; pilot in a non-sample site and instrument correction.	38
Phase 3 Baseline collection with remote oversight	Weeks 7 to 12 November to December 2026	Partner-led household survey across 126 clusters; partner-led FGDs and KIIs; rubric evidence assembled; daily dashboard review, back-checks, audio audits and same-day enumerator feedback; weekly data quality assurance returns to the CMU; rolling cleaning and panel identifier verification.	42
Phase 4 Analysis, rubric scoring and contribution	Weeks 13 to 17 December 2026 to January 2027	Index construction and documentation; weighted, disaggregated KPI benchmark tables; thematic coding and inter-coder checks; rubric panels scored and independently verified; triangulation, contribution assessment and contextual risk analysis; draft report and preliminary findings deck.	37
Phase 5 Validation, dissemination and close-out	Weeks 18 to 26 February to April 2027	CMU and NCRDS review; the one-day validation and dissemination workshop co-facilitated in Mogadishu with NCRDS and BRCiS; integration of feedback and of the recommendations from the partner-led field-level validation workshops; final report, final PowerPoint and the complete data package.	31

Table 7. The five phases, and the level of effort CRC places in each.

Five phases and five deliverables. Each deliverable is gated on written CMU approval before the next phase closes.

	OCT 2026	NOV 2026	DEC 2026	JAN 2027	FEB 2027	MAR 2027	APR 2027
WEEK	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Phase 1 · Inception and framework design, weeks 1 to 4							
Kick-off with the CMU and NCRDS; access and data-sharing agreements							
Desk review: KOBAC design, NSPAP, EU framework, AARAN and URBANISE tools							
Ten virtual key informant interviews with NCRDS, CMU, EU, partners, municipalities							
Theory of change articulation, evaluation questions and indicator matrix							
Sampling frame review with NCRDS and BRCiS members; sample allocation fixed							
D1 Inception Report submitted							
Phase 2 · Instruments, translation and training, weeks 5 to 8							
Household questionnaire, FGD and KII guides, KPI 1.1 rubric drafted							
Municipal inclusivity composite index specification, with the CMU							
Outcome 3 KPI module for the participant registration tool							
Somali translation and independent back-translation; instrument programming							
One-day in-person training in Mogadishu, NCRDS and implementing partners							
Pilot in a non-sample site; instruments and skip logic corrected							
D2 Tool pack and training report submitted							
Phase 3 · Baseline collection with remote oversight, weeks 7 to 12							
Partner-led household survey across 126 clusters, Afgoye and Jowhar							
Partner-led FGDs and KIIs; rubric evidence assembled							
Daily dashboard review, back-checks, audio audits, enumerator feedback							
Rolling data cleaning, panel identifier verification, transcript quality checks							
D3 Field oversight and data quality assurance pack submitted							
Phase 4 · Analysis, rubric scoring and contribution, weeks 13 to 17							
Index construction: Self-Reliance Index, municipal inclusivity composite							
Quantitative analysis and disaggregated KPI benchmark tables							
Thematic coding of qualitative data; rubric panels scored and verified							
Triangulation, contribution assessment, contextual risk analysis							
D4 Draft baseline report and preliminary findings deck submitted							
Phase 5 · Validation, dissemination and close-out, weeks 18 to 26							
CMU and NCRDS review of the draft; written comments consolidated							
One-day validation and dissemination workshop co-facilitated in Mogadishu							
Partner-led field-level validation; recommendations integrated into the report							
Final report, final PowerPoint, datasets, codebooks and syntax finalised							
D5 Final baseline report and full data package submitted							

	OCT 2026				NOV 2026				DEC 2026				JAN 2027				FEB 2027				MAR 2027				APR		
WEEK	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	
Weeks 7 and 8 overlap deliberately, so that pilot corrections reach the field inside the same week. The one-day training and the one-day validation workshop are the only in-person events, both in Mogadishu and both convened by the CMU.																											

7.1 Deliverables

All deliverables are submitted in English and in editable electronic format, in Microsoft Word, PowerPoint and PDF as the TOR requires, using BRCiS templates and formats where they apply and following the reporting and visibility conventions of EU-funded actions.

#	Deliverable	What it contains	Timing
D1	Inception Report	The refined evaluation methodology, the performance evaluation framework and evaluation questions, the full set of measurement instruments and guidance, the sampling strategy, the fieldwork plan, the stakeholder engagement approach, ethical considerations, stated limitations and a detailed workplan. Includes the findings of ten virtual key informant interviews and the alignment mapping against the NSPAP, EU requirements and the AARAN and URBANISE frameworks.	End of Week 4, October 2026
D2	Evaluation tool pack, Outcome 3 registration module and training delivery	Programmed household questionnaire, FGD and KII guides, the KPI I.I government capacity rubric, the municipal inclusivity composite index specification, the Outcome 3 KPI questionnaire for integration into the participant registration tool, the field manual and data quality assurance protocol, plus delivery of the one-day in-person training in Mogadishu and a training report with pre and post test results.	End of Week 8, November 2026
D3	Field oversight and data quality assurance pack	Weekly data quality assurance returns during collection, back-check and audio-audit results, the enumerator performance log, and the cleaned, de-identified baseline datasets with codebooks and reproducible cleaning syntax.	End of Week 12, December 2026
D4	Draft Baseline Evaluation Report and preliminary findings presentation	Pre-intervention benchmarks for all Impact, Outcome 1 and Outcome 2 KPIs at population level, disaggregated by location, gender, age and displacement status; the rubric assessment of government capacity; the contextual factors and risk analysis; and actionable recommendations for adaptive management. Accompanied by a concise PowerPoint presentation.	End of Week 17, January 2027
D5	Validation and dissemination workshop, and final Baseline Evaluation Report	Co-facilitation of the one-day validation and dissemination workshop in Mogadishu alongside NCRDS and BRCiS; integration of stakeholder feedback and of the recommendations generated by the partner-led field-level validation workshops; the final report, the final PowerPoint, and the complete data package in editable electronic format.	End of Week 26, April 2027

Table 8. Deliverables, contents and timing.

7.2 Payment milestones

The TOR asks that payment instalments align specifically with the submission and approval of the inception report, and with the submission and approval of the baseline report following the dissemination workshop. Our financial proposal follows that instruction exactly: forty per cent on written approval of D1, and sixty per cent on written approval of the final baseline report at D5. If the CMU would prefer a third intermediate tranche at D3 or D4 to smooth cash flow across the six months, we will accommodate it at no change to the total.

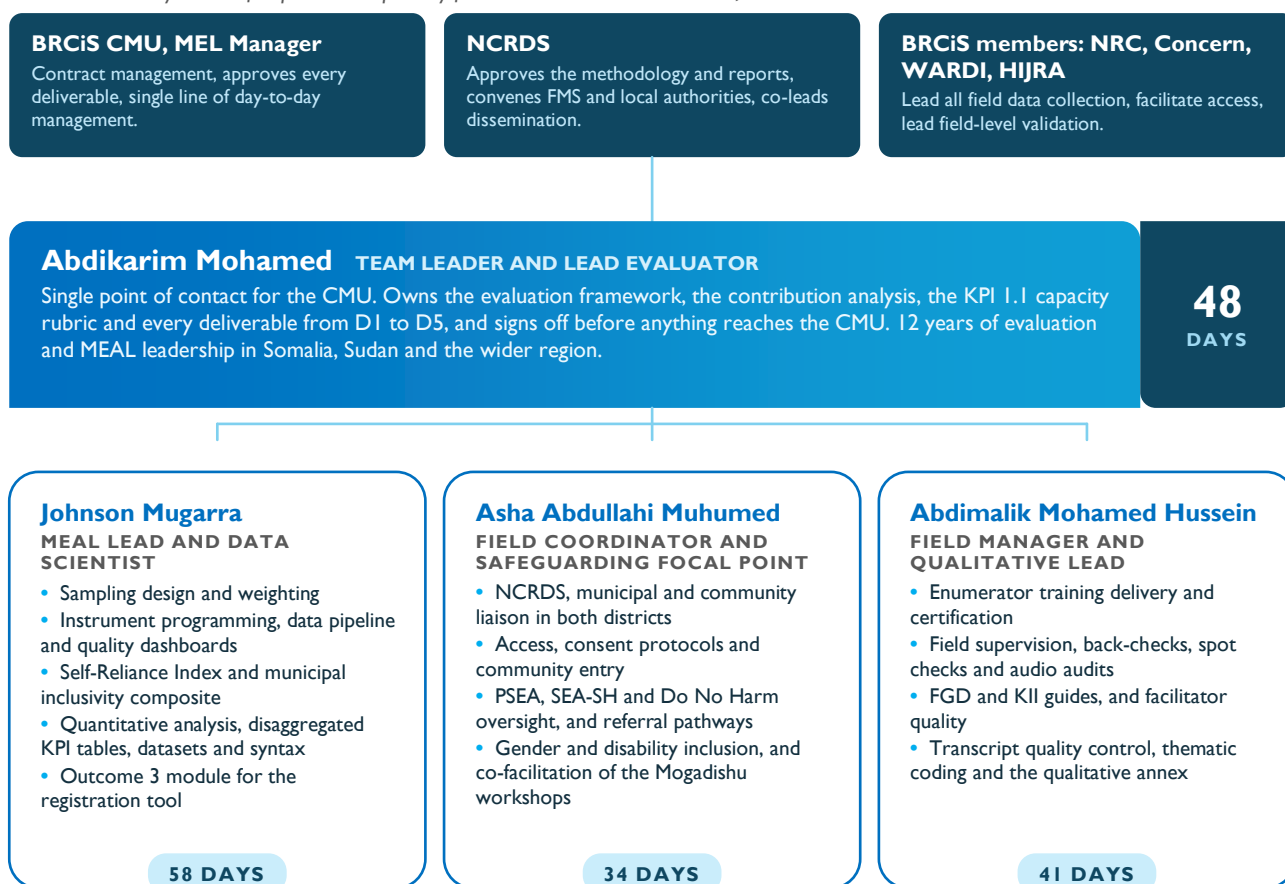
8. Team composition, roles and level of effort

Scored under Section 3, Clause 26.1: resume of each team member, team composition, organisational chart and clear delineation of roles, responsibilities and levels of effort, 25 points.

Four consultants deliver this assignment, carrying 181 days between them. The team is small on purpose. Because the TOR places all primary data collection with the implementing partners and government focal persons, what remains for the consultant is design, training, remote assurance, analysis and reporting, and that is senior work, which does not scale with headcount. Keeping the team at four means the people who design the framework are the people who analyse the data and write the report, which is the single most reliable protection against a baseline whose methods chapter and findings chapter do not quite match.

Figure 5. A four-person team, and who owns what

181 consultant days across five phases. No primary field data collection sits with CRC; the BRCiS members lead it and CRC assures it.



8.1 Roles and responsibilities against the TOR

The table below maps every task the TOR assigns to the evaluation consultant to the person accountable for it.

TOR requirement (Section 6, Evaluation Consultant)	Accountable	Supporting	Deliverables
Methodology and tool design, aligned to NCRDS plans, BRCiS frameworks, EU requirements, OECD-DAC criteria and the contribution analysis framework	Abdikarim Mohamed	Johnson Mugarra, Abdimalik Mohamed Hussein	D1, D2
Developing Outcome 3 KPI assessment questionnaires for integration into the participant registration tool	Johnson Mugarra	Abdikarim Mohamed	D2
Training BRCiS and NCRDS staff on evaluation tools and methodologies prior to collection, including the one-day Mogadishu session	Abdimalik Mohamed Hussein	Abdikarim Mohamed, Johnson Mugarra, Asha Abdullahi Muhumed	D2
Data collection oversight: remote supervision, technical backstopping, data quality assurance, enumerator performance	Johnson Mugarra	Abdimalik Mohamed Hussein	D3
Virtual key informant interviews with project stakeholders during the inception period	Abdikarim Mohamed	Asha Abdullahi Muhumed	D1
Analysis and reporting, including the inception report, the baseline report and workshop materials	Abdikarim Mohamed	Johnson Mugarra (quantitative), Abdimalik Mohamed Hussein (qualitative)	D1, D4, D5
Workshop facilitation: co-facilitating the baseline training and the validation and dissemination workshop in Mogadishu	Asha Abdullahi Muhumed	Abdikarim Mohamed	D2, D5
Integrating the recommendations from the partner-led field-level validation workshops into the final report	Abdikarim Mohamed	Asha Abdullahi Muhumed	D5

TOR requirement (Section 6, Evaluation Consultant)	Accountable	Supporting	Deliverables
Compliance and ethics: EU, FGS and NRC data protection standards, Do No Harm, NRC Code of Conduct and PSEA; and security and logistics for the consultant team throughout	Asha Abdullahi Muhumed	All team members, CRC Operations	All

Table 9. Every consultant task in Section 6 of the TOR, mapped to a named individual.

8.2 Level of effort by phase

Consultant and role	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	Total days
Abdikarim Mohamed Team Leader and Lead Evaluator	14	8	6	10	10	48
Johnson Mugarra MEAL Lead and Data Scientist	8	14	14	14	8	58
Asha Abdullahi Muhumed Field Coordinator and Safeguarding Focal Point	6	7	10	3	8	34
Abdimalik Mohamed Hussein Field Manager and Qualitative Lead	5	9	12	10	5	41
Total	33	38	42	37	31	181

Table 10. Level of effort in consultant days. Daily rates are in the separate financial proposal.

8.3 Team profiles

Structured CV summaries are at Annex A and full signed CVs at Annex B, as Section 7 of the TOR requires.

Abdikarim Mohamed, Team Leader and Lead Evaluator

An independent evaluator and MEAL specialist with more than 12 years across Somalia, Sudan and the wider East Africa region, building evaluation and accountability systems for donors and implementing partners from framework design and data systems through to outcome-level reporting. He holds an MBA in Management Strategy from the University of Zambia, a BA in International Relations from Savannah University in Mogadishu, and a Diploma in MEAL and Data Analysis, with additional certification in RCT design and gender-sensitive M&E. He is a member of the African Evaluation Association and founded the Somalia M&E and Statistician Experts Forum.

He was MEAL Coordinator for IRC Sudan and, from 2018 to 2023, for IRC Somalia, where he led RCT-based evaluations of youth and livelihood interventions in fragile contexts. Earlier he was MEL Adviser to RTI International on USAID education and governance programmes and an M&E Specialist with DAI Global on resilience and economic recovery. He led the Somalia JUSTPEACE and SOMLAW evaluation, assessing effectiveness, efficiency and impact for a project supporting law-making in the Federal Member States.

On this assignment. Single point of contact for the CMU, accountable for every deliverable. He owns the evaluation framework and the contribution analysis, designs and scores the KPI 1.1 rubric, runs the 10 virtual inception interviews, authors both reports and reviews every output before it reaches the CMU. Figure 5 sets out the full split of ownership.

Johnson Mugarra, MEAL Lead and Data Scientist

A data scientist and MEAL specialist and CRC's technical lead consultant, with over 5 years turning complex datasets into decision-ready evidence across agriculture, health, education and social services in East Africa. He holds an MSc in Data Science from Manipal University and a BSc in Agriculture from Makerere University, and is certified as a Microsoft Power BI Analyst, a SAS Statistical Business Analyst and a Tableau Business Intelligence Analyst. He works in R, Python, SQL, Stata, SPSS and SAS, and in ODK, Kobo and SurveyCTO.

He was a Research Associate with DLH Corporation on the USAID-funded SITES programme, running the data audits that verified reported results, and with Innovations for Poverty Action Uganda on the LEGO Creative Solutions project across Uganda and Ethiopia. With the Ministry of Agriculture, Catholic Relief Services and Makerere University he built predictive models integrating NASA weather data into agricultural planning, which is directly relevant to climate measurement in an East African dryland economy.

On this assignment. Sampling design, weighting and variance estimation; instrument programming and the case management that carries the panel identifiers; the daily quality dashboards; the Self-Reliance Index and municipal inclusivity composite; the Outcome 3 registration module; and the datasets, codebooks and syntax that make the midline reproducible.

Asha Abdullahi Muhumed, Field Coordinator and Safeguarding Focal Point

A senior community engagement and safeguarding specialist with over a decade of community-based project management across Somalia and Kenya, including direct municipal engagement on urban resilience programming and strong working relationships with Federal, Member State and local authorities. She holds a BA in Sociology from Moi University and a Diploma in Banking and Finance from Mount Kenya University.

She was community engagement specialist on the World Bank Somalia Urban Resilience Project II with Kismayo Municipality, the closest analogue to the municipal counterpart relationship this evaluation requires. She has been Community Participation Coordinator at Saferworld, Gender and Human Rights Adviser at the Ministry of Women, and Senior Safeguarding Officer at CARE International. Since 2023 she has been Field Coordinator at CRC, leading community feedback and response mechanisms and liaison with local authorities, partners and communities.

On this assignment. Liaison with NCRDS, the two municipalities and community structures; community entry, access and consent protocols; PSEA, SEA-SH and Do No Harm compliance as safeguarding focal point, including referral pathways; gender and disability inclusion across sampling and facilitation; and co-facilitation of both Mogadishu events.

Abdimalik Mohamed Hussein, Field Manager and Qualitative Lead

A field operations and M&E specialist with 6 years managing household surveys, perception studies and community assessments in fragile Somalia, combining an economics and finance background with hands-on participatory monitoring and large survey management. He holds an MSc in Finance from the University of Nairobi, a BSc in Economics and Management Science from Mogadishu University, and a Diploma in Quantitative Analysis, with certification in monitoring and evaluation from the Humanitarian Leadership Academy, in data quality management and analysis using Stata, and in Safeguarding Essentials.

At CRC since 2022 he has served as Monitoring and Evaluation Specialist, supporting field staff and enumerators on survey design, collection and analysis, running monitoring visits across Somali states and data quality assessments for partners. Earlier he was M&E Programme Manager at Mandera Relief Development Organization. He works in Kobo, ODK and ONA and is fluent in Somali and English.

On this assignment. Enumerator training and certification at the Mogadishu session and the two remote follow-ups; field supervision during partner-led collection, including back-checks, audio audits and the performance log; the FGD and KII guides and facilitation quality against them; transcript quality control; and the thematic coding that feeds the contribution assessment.

8.4 How the team meets the qualification requirements

This bid is submitted by the Center for Research and Communication, a limited liability company registered in Somalia, not by an individual consultant. The certificate of registration and the tax compliance certificate are at Annexes E and F.

Requirement in Section 7 of the TOR	How the team meets it
Advanced degree in economics, development studies, urban resilience, climate adaptation or a related field	Three of the four consultants hold a master's degree. Abdikarim Mohamed holds an MBA in Management Strategy and a BA in International Relations; Abdimalik Mohamed Hussein holds an MSc in Finance and a BSc in Economics and Management Science; Johnson Mugarra holds an MSc in Data Science. Asha Abdullahi Muhumed holds a BA in Sociology, which with 14 years of applied community and municipal engagement is the relevant qualification for the coordination role she holds here.
Minimum of 5 to 8 years leading complex performance evaluations, with expertise in contribution analysis, OECD-DAC criteria and mixed-methods design	Abdikarim Mohamed has 12 years leading evaluations across Somalia, Sudan and East Africa, including OECD-DAC structured evaluation of the JUSTPEACE and SOMLAW programme and RCT-based evaluation of livelihood interventions at IRC. CRC as a firm has delivered mixed-methods outcome evaluation with contribution analysis for the BRCiS Consortium and for IRC, UNICEF, NCA and Islamic Relief.
Proven experience designing and implementing longitudinal evaluations for durable solutions, displacement or humanitarian-development nexus projects	CRC designed the longitudinal pre-post evaluation framework with a contribution lens for the BRCiS URBANISE project across five Somali cities, covering baseline, midline and endline with a household panel. The team has delivered baseline and endline studies for displacement-affected populations for IRC, Islamic Relief and SOS Children's Villages.
Strong understanding of forced displacement, durable solutions frameworks, urban services and livelihoods in fragile and conflict-affected contexts	The whole team works in Somalia. Asha Abdullahi Muhumed worked on urban resilience and municipal service delivery with Kismayo Municipality under the World Bank; Abdikarim Mohamed has led displacement and protection evaluation at IRC in Somalia and Sudan; CRC has delivered the UNICEF accountability assessment across 24 South Central districts and displacement response studies in Berdale, Dinsoor and Baidoa.

Requirement in Section 7 of the TOR	How the team meets it
Substantial research work in climate resilience or a related field with a geographical focus on the drylands of the Horn of Africa, preferably in a fragile context	CRC has conducted the SOS Children's Villages baseline and market-based analysis on climate-smart and sustainable farming in Baidoa, climate-resilient WASH and livelihoods work with Welthungerhilfe, and the URBANISE climate resilience index design across five Somali cities. Johnson Mugarra's predictive modelling work for the Ministry of Agriculture integrated NASA climate data into agricultural planning models in the East African drylands.
Desirable: previous experience in Somalia, experience evaluating EU-funded projects, established presence in Somalia or partnership with local organisations	CRC is a Somali firm, registered and tax-compliant in Somalia, headquartered in Mogadishu with 13 years of continuous operation and resident field capacity in South Central Somalia. We currently hold an assignment with the BRCiS Consortium on the EU-funded KOBAC Action itself, and have delivered EU-relevant reporting for UN and INGO clients.

Table 11. The qualification requirements in Section 7, and the evidence for each.

9. Quality assurance, risk and value for money

9.1 Quality assurance

Quality is controlled at three points. Every instrument, dataset and report is reviewed and signed by the Team Leader before it reaches the CMU. Each phase is gated on written CMU approval of the preceding deliverable, so a methodological disagreement surfaces before work has been built on it. And two reconciliations run on every output: that the figures in the narrative match those in the tables and the underlying syntax, and that the disaggregation shown is the disaggregation the KPI definition requires, since the commonest defect in baseline reports is a table that reports by gender where the indicator demands gender, age and displacement status together.

9.2 Risks and mitigation

Risk	Likelihood	Our response
Post El Nino flooding or seasonal rain blocks access to sampled clusters during Phase 3	High	Float is carried in the Phase 3 window. A documented cluster substitution rule is agreed at inception, substituting only within the same stratum and settlement type, with every substitution recorded and reported. Any affected estimate is flagged in the report.
Security deterioration in Afgoye or Jowhar limits collection in specific areas	Medium	Collection is partner-led through NRC, Concern Worldwide, WARDI and HIJRA, who hold the access relationships. Coverage gaps are reported transparently with their effect on the domain estimate quantified, and the affected areas are recorded in the panel register for revisit at midline.
The sampling frame from NCRDS, the members and the municipalities is incomplete or out of date	Medium	Frame review is a Phase 1 activity with time budgeted for it. Where a settlement list is missing, a rapid listing is done before selection in that cluster. Frame limitations are documented in the inception report and their effect on weighting stated.
Partner enumerator capacity varies across four implementing organisations	Medium	One common training, one common protocol, one common instrument, and an enumerator performance log that tracks flags by individual across all four organisations. Two remote follow-up sessions in the first week of collection address the comprehension problems that only appear in real interviews.
Panel identifiers are lost, so the midline cannot revisit the same households	Medium	Identifiers are generated inside the instrument itself. GPS coordinates and two contact points are captured at first visit, duplicates are checked nightly, and the verified panel register is a named component of the D5 data package.
KPI 1.3 composite construction slips because the item set is not agreed in time	Medium	Specification is a Phase 2 activity with a named owner and a week 6 deadline, sitting before translation and programming. If agreement is not reached by then, the fallback is a documented provisional item set carried into the pilot, with the final weighting decided on baseline data.
Government counterparts are unavailable for the rubric panels or the inception interviews	Medium	NCRDS convenes Federal Member State and local authority participation under the TOR. Where a counterpart is unavailable, the rubric domain is scored from documentary evidence and third-party verification alone, and the reduced evidence base is stated in the score citation. Scope is held by the deliverable set and the approval gates.
Personal data is mishandled during transfer between four partners and the consultant	Low	A data processing and sharing agreement is signed with NRC before any data moves. Collection is direct to an encrypted server, personal identifiers are separated from analysis data at ingestion, and only the de-identified analysis dataset is shared beyond the named team.

Table 12. Principal risks and the response to each.

9.3 Value for money

The TOR states that proposals demonstrating cost-effective and streamlined approaches will be preferred, and three features of this offer respond to that directly. The budget is weighted toward senior professional time: four consultants, no subcontracted layer, and no enumerator costs, since field collection sits with the BRCiS members. Travel is limited to the two events the TOR requires in Mogadishu, with all other work done remotely. And we have not budgeted venue, refreshment or participant costs for the baseline training or the dissemination workshop, because Section 6 of the TOR places logistics and budget for both with the BRCiS CMU. Including them would have inflated our total against a cost the CMU is already carrying.

The more consequential economy is structural. The framework, question bank, panel register, index specifications and analysis syntax are built once and used three times, so whoever is separately contracted for the midline and endline inherits a working measurement system rather than a report. That is why we have put 33 days into inception.

9.4 Management arrangements

Day-to-day management runs through the BRCiS CMU, with the MEL Manager as our technical counterpart and Abdikarim Mohamed as the single point of contact from CRC. NCRDS approves the methodology and the reports and convenes Federal Member State and local authority participation. The BRCiS members lead field collection and facilitate access, and lead the field-level validation workshops whose recommendations we integrate into the final report. The EU reviews and participates in interviews and the dissemination workshop. We propose a short weekly call with the CMU during Phase 3, and a written progress note at the close of each phase.

CRC is responsible for its own security throughout, as Section 6 of the TOR sets out. We will request an NRC security briefing before each Mogadishu event. The team is resident in Mogadishu and moves on CRC arrangements with CRC-provided insurance, at no cost to NRC.

10. Ethics, safeguarding, data protection and Do No Harm

10.1 Ethical conduct of the evaluation

Participation is voluntary and informed. The consent script is read from the instrument and time-stamped, and it covers the purpose of the evaluation, what will be asked, how long it will take, how the data will be used and stored, the right to decline any question or to stop at any point, and the fact that participation carries no entitlement to assistance. Consent is obtained separately for audio recording in qualitative sessions. No one under eighteen is interviewed under this design. Interviews are conducted in the respondent's preferred language and in a location where they can speak without being overheard.

Do No Harm is applied to design decisions as well as to conduct. Focus groups are segmented by sex and, where relevant, by displacement status, because mixing them changes what can safely be said. Questions on tenure, grievance and social relations are framed so that answering does not expose a respondent to retaliation from a landlord, a clan authority or a local official, and group discussions are not held in locations associated with a single authority. Where a question is likely to raise expectations of assistance, the consent script addresses it explicitly.

10.2 Safeguarding, PSEA and referral

CRC maintains a PSEA policy aligned with the IASC six core principles, a Child Safeguarding Policy and a staff Code of Conduct. Everyone engaged on this assignment signs the Code and is briefed by the safeguarding focal point, Asha Abdullahi Muhumed, before any activity begins, and the same briefing forms part of the Mogadishu training for partner enumerators. We will sign NRC's Code of Conduct and PSEA policies during contracting, as Section 6 of the TOR requires.

A district-specific referral pathway is compiled during Phase I and issued to every enumerator as a card, listing the available protection, GBV, health and legal services in Afgoye and Jowhar with the referral route for each. Enumerators are trained on what to do if a protection concern is disclosed: stop, do not probe, offer the referral, record only what is necessary, and report through the safeguarding focal point the same day. Concerns involving CRC or partner personnel are routed confidentially, including to NRC's PSEA and Safeguarding Unit where its protocols require.

10.3 Data protection

CRC complies with the EU General Data Protection Regulation and will sign NRC's data processing and sharing agreement as part of the contract, as Section 3 Clause 3 of the ITB requires. Only the minimum personal data the evaluation needs is collected, captured directly to an encrypted server with transmission and at-rest encryption, with nothing left on enumerator devices after upload. Direct identifiers and the panel contact register are stored separately from the analysis dataset, linked only by a pseudonymous panel identifier and restricted to two named team members; the analysis dataset is de-identified before any sharing. A retention and handover plan is agreed with the CMU at

inception, covering who holds the panel register between waves, which is the one file the midline cannot function without and the one that carries the most personal data.

10.4 Inclusion

Gender, age, disability and displacement status are inclusion requirements written into the design, and they shape sampling before they shape reporting. The household selection protocol alternates the sex of the respondent by cluster so that women are not systematically under-represented; two of the sixteen focus groups are held with persons with disabilities, and all group venues are checked for physical accessibility during the Phase I access assessment. Instruments include the Washington Group short set so disability disaggregation is possible and consistent, women's and youth groups are facilitated by women, and all reporting is disaggregated by location, gender, age band and displacement status as the logframe requires.

11. Compliance matrix

ITB requirement	Points	Where answered
Cover letter introducing the consultants, with team composition and roles	5	Cover letter, after the title page
Technical proposal of no more than 20 pages	n/a	Sections 1 to 12; letter and annexes sit outside the count
A proposed performance evaluation framework and evaluation questions	10	Section 4, with Figures 1 and 2 and Tables 3, 4 and 5
Sampling methodology and data collection strategies	10	Section 5, with Figure 3 and Table 6
Data analysis approaches	10	Section 6
A detailed workplan with deliverables and associated timelines	10	Section 7, with Figure 4 and Tables 7 and 8
Understanding of the TOR and the measurement methods; alignment of the tools with NCRDS, BRCIS and EU requirements	n/a	Sections 3, 3.1, 4.1, 4.2, 4.4 and 6.4, with Figure 1 and Table 4
Experience of similar assignments, at least two with references; consortium experience preferred	10	Section 2.1 and Table 1; referees at Annex C
Resume of each member; team composition, organisational chart, roles and levels of effort	25	Section 8, Figure 5, Tables 9 to 11, Annexes A and B
Financial proposal in USD: fees, logistics, auxiliary costs	20 (fin.)	Separate document, per Section 8 of the ITB
Payment instalments aligned to approval of D1 and of D5	n/a	Section 7.2 and the financial proposal
Sections 5 to 9 signed and stamped; registration, profile, tax	Pass	With this bid; Section 2.2, Annexes E and F

Table 13. Compliance against ITB Section 3, Clause 26.1, and Section 4.

12. Annexes

- A.** Structured CV summaries.
- B.** Signed CVs.
- C.** Two comparable assignments with referees.
- D.** Client references.
- E.** Company profile and registration.
- F.** Tax compliance certificate.
- G.** Financial proposal, separate.
- H.** ITB Sections 5 to 9, signed.